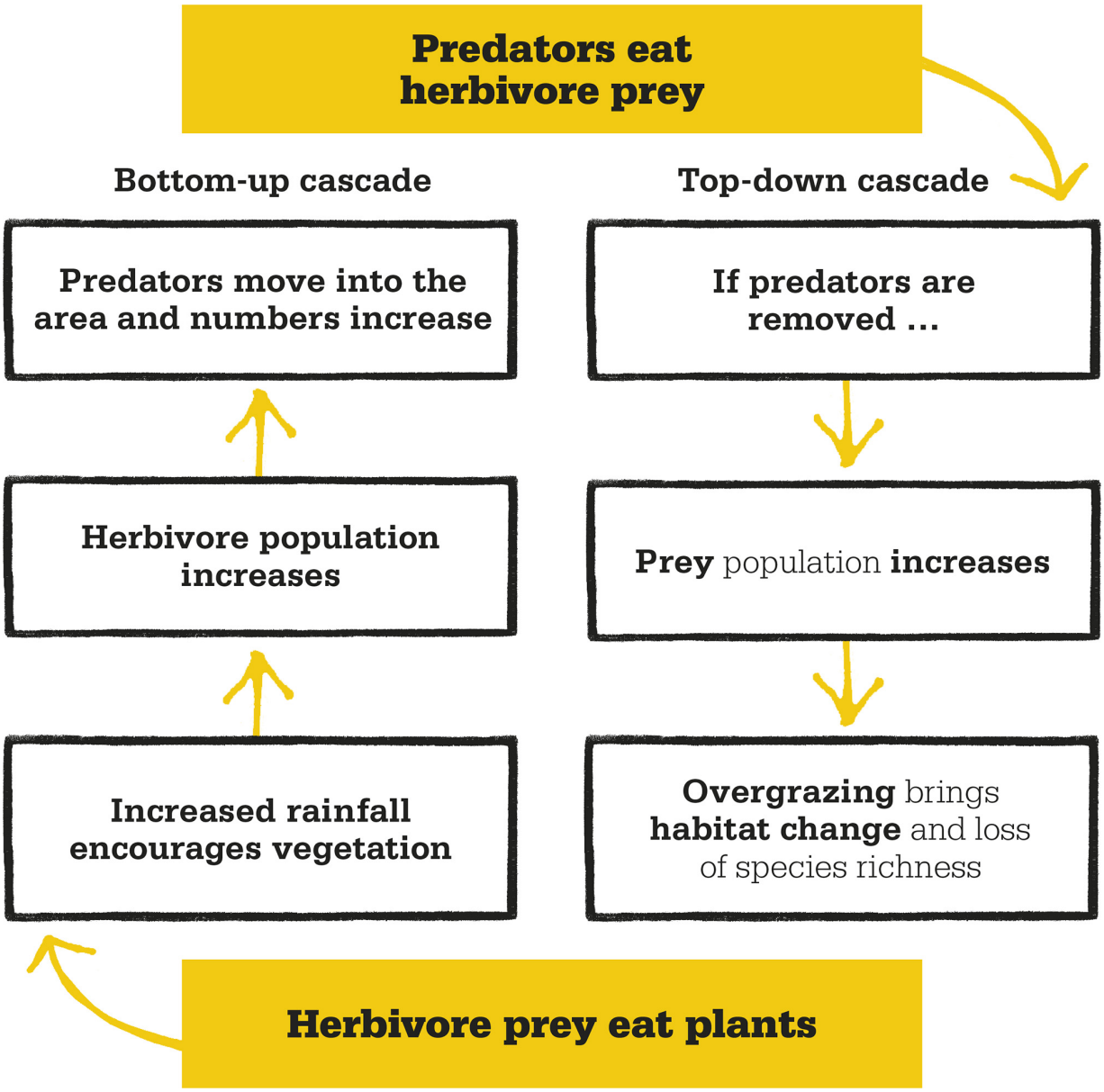


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Controlling factors

In 1960, the American ecologist Nelson Hairston and his colleagues Frederick Smith and Lawrence Slobodkin published a key paper entitled “Community Structure, Population Control, and Competition,” which examined the factors that control populations of animals on different trophic levels. They concluded that populations of producers, carnivores, and